"I'll always be behind everyone else."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Being the last to finish, needing extra help, or taking longer can make us feel in a permanent race we cannot win. Comparison drains energy and joy.

What Scripture teaches

"Let us run with endurance the race set out for us" (Hebrews 12:1). It is our race, not someone else's. "The race is not to the swift" (Ecclesiastes 9:11). "Let us not grow weary in well-doing, for in due time we will reap a harvest if we do not give up." Each person has a different path and pace. God is concerned with faithfulness, not speed, and He rejoices in your steps.

> *"Therefore, since we are surrounded by such a great cloud of witnesses, let us throw off every encumbrance and the sin that so easily entangles, and let us run with endurance the race set out for us"* (Hebrews 12:1).

Also see

> "I saw something else under the sun: The race is not to the swift, nor the battle to the strong; neither is the bread to the wise, nor the wealth to the intelligent, nor the favor to the skillful. For time and chance happen to all" (Ecclesiastes 9:11).

> "Let us not grow weary in well-doing, for in due time we will reap a harvest if we do not give up" (Galatians 6:9).

> "Each one should test his own work. Then he will have reason to boast in himself alone, and not in someone else" (Galatians 6:4).

> "The steps of a man are ordered by the LORD who takes delight in his journey" (Psalm 37:23).

Common self-statements

- Everyone passes me.
- I will never catch up.
- I am always last.
- They finish before I start.
- I am slow at everything.
- There is no use.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either ahead or behind.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that I will never catch up.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling slow and concluding I am behind in life.
- Social comparison: Calling myself behind.

Challenging questions

- Who am I comparing myself to, and why?

- What progress have I made compared with myself last year?
- What areas am I not behind in?
- What is a reasonable pace for me?
- What does Scripture say about running my own race?
- Whom can I walk with at my pace?

Truth summary

> I am running my own race, at my own pace, with God's help. Progress matters more than comparison, and faithfulness matters more than speed.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Envy/Jealousy
- Self-Esteem, Low
- Dissatisfaction
- Humility
- Faith

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Thinking, Healthy
- Pride

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Already There — Casting Crowns
God's perspective extends beyond what we can currently understand.

Thrive — Casting Crowns
Life rooted in God includes purposeful growth and joy, not merely surviving or staying busy.

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Great Is Thy Faithfulness — CeCe Winans
This classic hymn recalls God's steady mercy through changing circumstances.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

My Plan for Replacing "I'll always be behind everyone else"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I'll always be behind everyone else." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who am I comparing myself to, and why?
- ☐ What progress have I made compared with myself last year?
- ☐ What areas am I not behind in?
- ☐ What is a reasonable pace for me?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about running my own race?
- ☐ Whom can I walk with at my pace?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I run my own race.
- ☐ The race is not just to the swift.
- ☐ I will not grow weary.
- ☐ Progress counts.
- ☐ God delights in my steps.
- ☐ I can walk with others.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Hebrews 12:1**
  "Therefore, since we are surrounded by such a great cloud of witnesses, let us throw off every encumbrance and the sin that so easily entangles, and let us run with endurance the race set out for us."
- ☐ **Ecclesiastes 9:11**
  "I saw something else under the sun: The race is not to the swift, nor the battle to the strong; neither is the bread to the wise, nor the wealth to the intelligent, nor the favor to the skillful. For time and chance happen to all."
- ☐ **Galatians 6:9**
  "Let us not grow weary in well-doing, for in due time we will reap a harvest if we do not give up."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] My pace: Each week, note one improvement from last month.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Hebrews 12:1 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I will run with endurance the race set out for me.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Envy/Jealousy" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] Compare with yourself. Write one thing better than last year.
- [ ] Set a pace. Choose a realistic goal.
- [ ] Find a companion. Walk with someone at your pace.
- [ ] Read Hebrews 12:1. Run your race.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I'll always be behind everyone else": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	My pace
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I'll always be behind everyone else.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I feel behind. Help me run my race at my pace, grateful for progress, and free from comparison. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.